

SUPPLY ALWAYS COMES ON THE HEELS OF DEMAND.

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Getting what we need

In economics, the market is not a place, but the way in which we can get the things we need, such as our food, clothes, and appliances. It is also the way that producers of these things can offer them to us for sale. A producer of bicycles, for example, could put them up for sale on a market stall, but is more likely to sell them in stores and over the internet—these are different ways of putting them “on the market.”

Markets began when people came to a particular place, the marketplace, to buy and sell things. At the stalls, sellers offered goods—things they had produced, such as food—or services—things that they could do, such as cutting hair. In modern towns and cities, traditional markets are less common and have been replaced by supermarkets and shopping centers, selling everything from groceries to electronics to clothes. Services can also be found in downtown areas and in shopping centers. Hairdressers, lawyers, restaurants, and opticians all offer their expertise from their stores and offices.